



The budget truly wireless earphones space is unnerving to navigate because of the sheer number of options. It is one of the most crowded and cutthroat product categories in India with choices ranging from a mere ₹500 up to ₹5,000. The best earphones in this space often punch way above their weight, offering an excellent blend of features and value. We're also seeing high-quality codecs, Active Noise Cancellation, app support, customisable EQs, and other such nifty features making it down to this affordable price point. The winner of this category is truly special though – it breaks conventions and opts for a more audiophile-friendly sound profile. Let's find out which TWS came out on top.

Zero1 Award Winner: **OPPO Enco Air3 Pro**

In July 2023, I called the OPPO Enco Air3 Pro the best-sounding TWS under ₹5,000 in my review, and that statement stands true even today. It blows the competition out of the water because of its honest representation of frequencies across the board. There are very few earphones in this price range, especially consumer-grade ones, that can appeal to beginner audiophiles. The OPPO Enco Air3 Pro is one such pair of TWS earphones. Sporting the world's first bamboo fibre diaphragm, the OPPO Enco Air3 Pro knocks

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2023



Realme Buds Air 5 Pro

Price: ₹4,999

it out of the park in the sonic department, with the most clean-sounding highs I've ever experienced at this price point. Moreover, you get LDAC codec support which allows 990 kbps transmission speeds, allowing for superb high-res sound. Vocals are clear, have great timbre, and sound detailed. The highs are nice and sparkly as well. The earbuds have excellent passive isolation, and when you add up to 49 dB Active Noise Cancellation to the mix, you've got yourself a fairly immersive auditory experience. The battery life isn't at par with competition though, which is one of its only cons. That aside, the OPPO Enco Air3 Pro also comes packing other niceties such as extension customisation via the accompanying HeyMelody app, low latency mode, fast charging, and much more. A truly deserving winner of this year's Digit Zero1 Award!

Runner-up and Best Buy: **Realme Buds Air 5 Pro**

The Realme Buds Air 5 Pro is a "bass lover's dream", as my colleague Satvik aptly opined in his review of this product. The product employs co-axial dual drivers in these earbuds – each handling a different part of the frequency spectrum and it does a fairly good job at doing that. There is some auditory masking in the mids and low-highs, but it isn't unpleasant. No one but audiophiles will take offence to this bass-forward sound signature approach. Moreover, the Realme Link app provides plenty of EQ presets to play around with if you aren't a fan of the default sound signature. More than the sound, it is the feature set that makes the Realme Buds Air 5 Pro such a stellar purchase under ₹5,000. Believe it or not, this one actually packs far more features than the OPPO Enco Air3 Pro which already scored really high in our features section. You've got ANC, app support, and such features which have gotten fairly common at the ₹5K mark. What sells these earphones for me is the addition of things such as 360-degree spatial audio and Personalised Audio. The kicker is that the spatial audio feature is implemented extremely well for a product this affordable! Additionally, there's LDAC codec support, Hi-Res audio certification, low latency mode, Google Fast Pair, Dual Device Connection and much more. A feature set like this is often absent even at the ₹10K price point, which is why the Realme Buds Air 5 Pro easily snags the Digit Best Buy Award.

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Budget Truly Wireless Earphones

Sonic excellence on a budget



OPPO Enco Air3 Pro

Price: ₹4,999